Tracker for GitHub

Why it matters and what it could become · a one-page thesis · October 2026

The bet. The GitHub contribution graph is the most-looked-at picture of a developer's work. It's on every profile and shows up in résumés and hiring screens, and plenty of people keep their streaks going just to see it stay green. But you have to open a browser and go looking for it. Tracker for GitHub puts that picture, and GitHub's own Activity overview chart, in the Mac menu bar, on the desktop and in Notification Center. It doesn't need an account, a server or any tracking.

Why now

- **The existing tools are abandoned.** Most contribution widgets haven't been updated in years. Their reviews say things like "every username is invalid."
- **Nobody shows the Activity overview.** We verified the Commits / Issues / PRs / Code review chart can be read publicly, with no login.
- **macOS 14 made widgets interactive**, so "flip through the people I follow" works on the desktop for the first time.

Who it's for

- **Builders keeping a streak.** A 7-day strip in the menu bar is a gentle daily nudge.
- **People who follow people.** Managers, mentors, teachers and friends can swipe through up to 10 favorites.
- **Widget people.** A glanceable graph on the desktop that refreshes itself.

What success looks like in year one

- Steady release downloads, stars and outside pull requests.
- Fixes within days whenever GitHub changes its pages.
- There are no analytics on purpose, so downloads, stars and contributors are the scoreboard.

How an open-source tool like this grows

- **It markets itself.** Every screenshot of a green widget is an ad, and developers post their setups.
- **GitHub-native distribution.** README, topics, Releases and a Pages site, then a Homebrew tap and a Show HN post.
- **Trust as the feature.** No analytics, MIT license, public code and a Keychain-only token.
- **Contributors.** One tested parser module with saved fixtures makes outside fixes easy and safe.
- **Sustainability.** GitHub Sponsors. No paid tier, no lock-in.

What v2 and beyond could become

- **v2: your work, not just your graph.** Sign in to see open issues as cards by repo, with label filters, one-click close and "my issues" widgets.
- **Teams and cohorts.** A small dashboard for a class or an open-source team.
- **Goals.** Local streak reminders and weekly summaries.
- **Everywhere.** iPhone and iPad widgets, a notarized build and Homebrew.
- **Beyond GitHub.** GitLab and Codeberg, using the same tested design.